

Nicolas Wessler

Ph.D. Candidate, UBC Sauder School of Business

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Research Interests

International Trade, Political Economy, Economic History

Education

University of British Columbia , Sauder School of Business	2021 - present
Ph.D. in Strategy and Business Economics	
Committee: Keith Head, Ayumu Ken Kikkawa, Nathan Nunn	
Advanced Studies Program, Kiel Institute for the World Economy (Germany)	2018 - 2019
Master of Science in Economics, University of Pavia (Italy)	2017 - 2018
Master of Science in Economics, University of Tübingen (Germany)	2016 - 2017
Visiting Student, Kasetsart University (Thailand)	2015 - 2016
Bachelor of Science in Economics, University of Münster (Germany)	2012 - 2016

Research and Work Experience

Pre-Doctoral Research Associate , University of Chicago	2019 - 2021
Prof. Felix Tintelnot & Dr. Alessandra González	
Research Assistant , United Nations ESCAP (Thailand)	2019
Research Assistant , Prof. Andreas Fuchs, Kiel Institute for the World Economy	2018 - 2019
Intern , Economic Policy Forum (Germany)	2016

Awards and Scholarships

UBC Killam Graduate Teaching Award	2025/2026
ReCIPE PhD Research Grant, UK Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office (FCDO)	2025
EDI Research Catalyst Funding, UBC Dhillon Centre	2024
Doctoral Recruitment Fellowship, UBC Sauder School of Business	2021 - 2026
ASP Scholarship, Kiel Institute for the World Economy	2018 - 2019
DAAD Full Year Scholarship	2017

Publications

Trade Reliance and the Success of Economic Sanctions

Review of World Economics, <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10290-026-00659-y>

The Glass Web: Kinship Networks, Female Executives and Firm Outcomes in the Middle East (with Alessandra L. González)

Economics of Transition and Institutional Change, <https://doi.org/10.1111/ecot.70037>

Working Papers

The Cost of Rivalry: Geopolitical Fragmentation and Trade during the Cold War

(with Timothy Meyer, Job Market Paper)

Hegemonic Competition with Carrots and Sticks

(with Timothy Meyer)

Presentations

2026: 24th Annual GEP/CEPR Postgrad Conference (Nottingham), Cowles Summer Conference on International Trade (Yale), 8th International Conference on European Economics and Politics (ETH Zurich)

2025: GSIPE Conference (Berkeley), Second Annual Workshop on Sanctions (Vienna), 59th Annual Meetings of the Canadian Economics Association (Montreal), Philly Trade Group at Drexel (Philadelphia)

2024: 58th Annual Meetings of the CEA (Toronto), RIEF Doctoral Meeting (Paris)

Referee Services

Review of World Economics

Other Services

President, UBC Sauder Ph.D. Student Society 2024

Organizer, UBC Trade/Spatial Brownbag Seminar Series 2024

Teaching Experience

University of British Columbia — Instructor

COMM 394: Environment, Society and Government (Undergraduate) Summer 2025

Enrollment: 36 students Teaching load: 6 hrs/week Teaching evaluation: 4.9 / 5.0

University of British Columbia — Teaching Assistant

COMR 493: Strategic Management in Business (Undergraduate) Winter 2024, Winter 2023

COMR 491: Strategic Management (Undergraduate) Winter 2023

COEC 498: Advanced International Business Management (Undergraduate) Winter 2023

COMM 498: International Business Management (Undergraduate) Winter 2022

ECON 455: International Trade (Undergraduate) Winter 2022, Winter 2023

Skills

Languages: English (fluent), German (native), Italian (beginner)

Software: R, Stata, Python, Julia, MATLAB

References

Keith Head

Sauder School of Business, UBC
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Ayumu Ken Kikkawa

Sauder School of Business, UBC
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Nathan Nunn

Department of Economics, UBC
nathan.nunn@ubc.ca

Updated: July 20, 2026